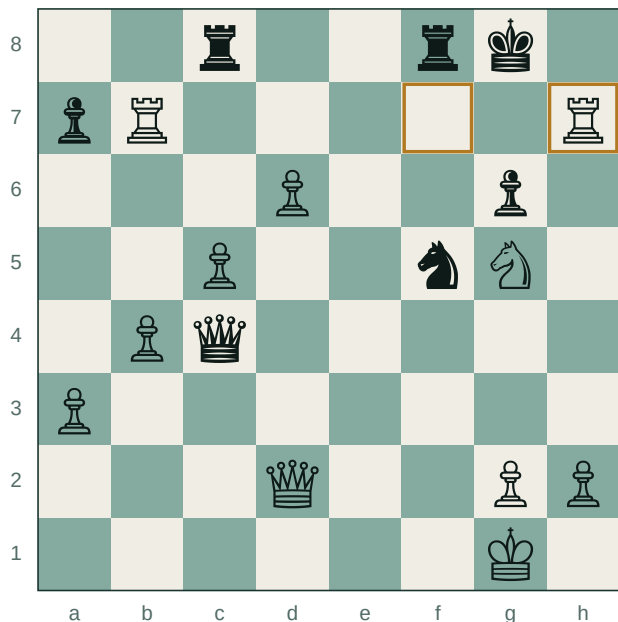


Double checks: Black, move 35

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Rxh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35...Qf1+ 36. Kxf1 Ng3+ 37. Ke1 Rf1#

35...Qf1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **36.Kxf1**.

36...Ng3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on f8 attacks the king on f1. Recorded reply: **37.Ke1**.

37...Rf1# Mate: rook on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on d2. Check for tactical protection.